

generating solar power costs only Rs 13-15 per unit.

Based on the current prices and assuming that one takes advantage of the 80 per cent depreciation permitted on such investments, in the first year the cost of power per unit (kWh) from a well-maintained solar plant will be less than Rs 8 per watt for a plant of any capacity between 5 kW and 1 MW. Thus solar rooftop installation is a good investment option considering both tangible and intangible benefits.

The government is also encouraging the use of rooftop power plants as a substitute for diesel-consuming and polluting DG sets. Most commercial buildings are dependent on diesel generators during power cuts. Investing in a rooftop solar power plant can offset diesel consumption and make the returns attractive. Added to this, the 30 per cent central finance assistance (CFA) in the form of capital

subsidy would encourage investors. With a rooftop installation, one can recover the project's cost within five to six years. Also, typically, a solar power plant has a life of 25 years with proper maintenance.

The return on investment (ROI) completely depends on the power purchase agreement signed by the project developer. While earlier the buying rate for power was Rs 17 per unit, today companies are ready to sell it at Rs 11 per unit, making only a marginal profit. Considering the current trend, the power purchase price can be estimated at Rs 13-14, so one can expect ROI within six to seven years.

More benefits for commercial units

Rooftop installation makes more sense for commercial establishments as these can utilise the solar power during peak-load daytime periods, thus saving the money required to set up

battery banks. Any amount of power not used can be stored in a battery bank for use at night when energy consumption is the least (about 10 per cent compared to the day).

Moreover, for small business establishments or small and medium enterprises (SMEs), a rooftop installation for grid connection is far more profitable than a multi-megawatt plant, which requires installation of six to eight transformers. Transformers are at most 98 per cent efficient and therefore while generating solar power, some energy is lost due to the inefficiency of these transformers. So it is profitable to install smaller power plants with 100 per cent of electricity production, which can then be transferred to the local utility.

Government's role in encouraging small producers

Change in government policies will

LED DRIVERS

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SOLAR CHARGE CONTROLLERS

INDOOR APPLICATION



AC 1W to 37500mA
AC 3W to 37500mA

OUTDOOR APPLICATION



AC 10W to 37500mA
AC 10W to 37500mA

SOLAR CHARGE CONTROLLERS



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12V/10A-BASIC / DSD

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DC 13500mA/700mA

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- Auto-adjustable output voltages

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